CSc 110 Computer Programming I

Gittings Bldg, Rm 129B, MoWeFr 2:00pm-2:50pm

Course Description

An introduction to programming with an emphasis on solving problems drawn from a variety of domains. Topics include basic control and data structures, problem solving strategies, and software development tools and techniques.

Instructor and Contact Information

Professor Hudson Lynam, GS Room 823, 775-750-5038, hlynam@arizona.edu

Office Hours: Monday & Wednesday, 12:45pm-1:45pm

For additional information, including TA office hours, please use the course website.

Course Format and Teaching Methods

This course is scheduled to be an in-person course, meeting in-person three times a week. Your meeting time should be:
Gittings Bldg, Rm 129B, Monday, Wednesday, and Friday 2:00pm-2:50pm
This is a four-unit course, meeting in the lecture room three times a week, and once each Friday for the weekly discussion period. Check your course registry for the time and location of the weekly discussion period.

Attendance is expected and required.

Course Objectives

By the end of the semester, you should be able to write complete, well-structured programs in python.

Expected Learning Outcomes

A successful CSc 110 student will be able to:

- Use variables, control structures, basic data types, lists, dictionaries, file I/O, and functions to write correct 100 - 200 line programs.
- Decompose a problem into an appropriate set of functions, loops, conditionals, and/or other control flow.
- Find bugs when code is not working as expected using print statements and computational thinking skills, and will be able to understand and resolve errors.
- Write clean, well-structured, and readable code.
- Follow a provided style guide to write clean, well-structured, and readable code.
- Demonstrate an understanding of the conceptual memory model underlying the data types covered in class.

(These learning outcomes are derived from those developed by Allison Obourn, Ben Dicken, Adriana Picoral and other faculty at the UA).

Transferable Career Skills

National Association of Colleges and Employers (NACE) Career Readiness:

Career readiness is a foundation from which to demonstrate requisite core competencies that broadly prepare the college-educated for success in the workplace and lifelong career management. For new college graduates, career readiness is key to ensuring successful entrance into the workforce.

There are eight career readiness competencies, each of which can be demonstrated in a variety of ways." (NACE, 2025)

- Career & Self Development
- Communication
- Critical Thinking
- Equity & Inclusion
- Leadership
- Professionalism
- Teamwork
- Technology

In this course, we will focus on the following competencies:

- **Technology**: Students will use technology to design and write complete, well-structured programs in Python.
- **Teamwork**: The course will include lectures, in-class discussions, and activities, with a strong emphasis on teamwork through group work that requires collaboration with other students during class.
- **Communication**: Students are encouraged to emphasize communication by interacting with teaching assistants and using various channels, such as office hours, Gradescope, class discussions, and Piazza, to stay updated on course materials.

Makeup Policy for Students Who Register Late

If you register after the first class meeting you may make up missed assignments within your first week of attendance.

Course Communications

All online communication will be conducted through my official UA e-mail address (hlynam@arizona.edu), D2L, and Piazza. Ask questions on Piazza when you have questions about assignments, quizzes, and exams (has private options). Email the instructor only when you have logistics-related questions.

Required Texts or Readings

All readings, videos, and assignment instructions will be available in the course website.

Course D2L: https://d2l.arizona.edu/d2l/home/1811183
Course Gradescope: https://www.gradescope.com/courses/1357088
Course website: https://professorlynam.github.io/csc110/
Piazza: https://piazza.com/arizona/fall2026/csc110001

Assignments and Examinations: Schedule/Due Dates

The breakdown of grades in this course is as follows:

45% exams
20% weekly quizzes
5% programming problems
10% short programming projects
10% programming projects
10% class attendance

There will be three exams (each 15%) throughout the course (including two midterms and one final exam), for a total of 45%. These exams may cover material from class, the programming assignments, the projects, and the readings. At the end of the semester, if at least two-thirds of the students have submitted class evaluations, we replaced your lowest midterm exam score with a percentage-equivalent copy of your final exam score, if the final exam score is higher than your lowest midterm score. We do this not only to encourage class evaluations, but also to reward you for demonstrating an improved mastery of the material over the course of the semester. If you would like an exam regraded, we reserve the right to regrade the entire exam, not only the parts you might question.

The midterm exams will be on:

Midterm Exam 1 - Wed, October 7
Midterm Exam 2 - Wed, November 4
You must keep theses dates available. Do not schedule any flights, travel plans, or other conflicts with these exams.

Weekly quizzes will be held every Wednesday (unless otherwise noted). There will be a total of 11 quizzes. Make-up quizzes will not be offered, however, your 2 lowest quiz scores will be dropped when calculating your final grade.

For programming problems, short projects and long projects, late work is NOT accepted.

Class attendance will be checked periodically at the discretion of the instructor.

Final Examination

The final exam is worth 15%.

The final exam date, time and room is: 12/11/26, 3:30pm-5:30pm, Room TBA.

You must keep this time available. Do not schedule any flights, travel plans, or other conflicts with this exam.

See also: Final Exam Regulations and Final Exam Schedule: https://registrar.arizona.edu/faculty-staff-resources/room-class-scheduling/schedule-classes/final-exams

Grading Scale and Policies

The instructor and teaching staff will do their best to have grades back to students within 1 week. This includes, but is not limited to, grades for exams, projects, programming assignments, attendance, and quizzes. Once a grade has been entered for a particular item on the digital grade-book, students have **at most 5 days** to dispute the grade. This includes disputes related to excuses such as sickness, personal matters, dean's excuses, etc. If 5 days pass and there has not been such a request, the grade is final. Appeals submitted after this period will not be considered by the instructor or teaching staff under any circumstances. Please review your grades promptly and plan accordingly.

The correspondence between percentage grade and numeric grade is as follows:

Greater or equal to 90% at least an A

Greater or equal to 80% at least a B

Greater or equal to 70% at least a C

Greater or equal to 60% at least a D

Anything less, at least an E / F

Department of Computer Science Grading Policy:

Instructors will explicitly promise when every assignment and exam will be graded and returned to students. These promised dates will appear in the syllabus, associated with the corresponding due dates and exam dates.

Graded homework will be returned before the next homework is due.

Exams will be returned “promptly”, as defined by the instructor (and as promised in the syllabus).

Grading delays beyond promised return-by dates will be announced as soon as possible with an explanation for the delay.

Incomplete (I) or Withdrawal (W):

Requests for incomplete (I) or withdrawal (W) must be made in accordance with University policies, which are available at https://catalog.arizona.edu/policy/courses-credit/grading/grading-system.

Class Participation Policies

Students are expected to participate in in-class activities, including completing ungraded practice programming problems. Class attendance is required. Excused absences are given at the discretion of the instructor, although Dean’s Excuses are always honored as according to university policies.

Class Absence Policies

If a student misses class, they are expected to catch up, completing the practice programming problems and going over any material they missed. Learning what materials have been missed can be done by reaching out via office hours (especially TA office hours), email, or with the help of fellow students.

Honors Credit

Students wishing to contract this course for Honors Credit should e-mail me to set up an appointment to discuss the terms of the contact and to sign the Honors Course Contract Request Form. The form is available at http://www.honors.arizona.edu/honors-contracts

Scheduled Topic and Activities

Week	***Module***	***Topic***
1	*Module 1*	*Python Basics (constants, variables, comments, strings, print)*
2	*Module 2*	*Operators and Expressions, functions*
3	*Module 3*	*Functions, decomposition*
4	*Module 4*	*Functions, input from user, decomposition*
5	*Module 5*	*Control Flow (if statements)*
6	*Module 6*	*Control Flow (while)*
7	*Module 7*	*Data Structures (lists)*
8	*Module 8*	*Control Flow (for loops), mutability, random*
9	*Module 9*	*Control Flow (for loops), Dictionaries*
10	*Module 10*	*Files and strings*
11	*Module 11*	*Data Structures (tuples)*
12	*Module 12*	*2D lists, nested for loops*
13	*Module 13*	*Data Structures (sets)*
14	*Module 14*	*Mutability*
15	*Module 15*	*Control Flow + Data Structures*

Assignment Due Dates

Assessment	Date	Time/Location
Quiz 01	August 26	in class
Quiz 02	September 2	in class

Assessment	Date	Time/Location
Module 1 Programming Problems	September 4	9pm
Short Programming Project 1	September 4	9pm
Quiz 03	September 9	in class
Module 2 Programming Problems	September 9	9pm
Short Programming Project 2	September 11	9pm
Programming Project 1	September 11	9pm
Quiz 04	September 16	in class
Module 3 Programming Problems	September 16	9pm
Short Programming Project 3	September 18	9pm
Programming Project 2	September 18	9pm
Quiz 05	September 23	in class
Module 4 Programming Problems	September 23	9pm
Short Programming Project 4	September 25	9pm
Programming Project 3	September 25	9pm
Quiz 06	September 30	in class
Module 5 Programming Problems	September 30	9pm
Short Programming Project 5	October 2	9pm
Programming Project 4	October 2	9pm
Midterm 1	October 7	in class
Module 6 Programming Problems	October 7	9pm
Short Programming Project 6	October 9	9pm
Programming Project 5	October 9	9pm
Quiz 07	October 14	in class
Module 7 Programming Problems	October 14	9pm
Short Programming Project 7	October 16	9pm
Programming Project 6	October 16	9pm
Quiz 08	October 21	in class
Module 8 Programming Problems	October 21	9pm
Short Programming Project 8	October 23	9pm
Programming Project 7	October 23	9pm
Quiz 09	October 28	in class
Module 9 Programming Problems	October 28	9pm
Midterm 2	November 4	in class
Module 10 Programming Problems	November 4	9pm
Short Programming Project 9	November 6	9pm
Programming Project 8	November 6	9pm
Module 11 Programming Problems	November 11	9pm
Short Programming Project 10	November 13	9pm
Programming Project 9	November 13	9pm
Quiz 10	November 18	in class
Module 12 Programming Problems	November 18	9pm
Short Programming Project 11	November 20	9pm

Assessment	Date	Time/Location
Programming Project 10	November 20	9pm
Quiz 11	December 2	in class
Module 13 Programming Problems	December 2	9pm
Programming Project 11	December 4	9pm
Short Programming Project 12	December 4	9pm
Module 14 Programming Problems	December 9	9pm
Programming Project 12	December 9	9pm
Final Exam	December 11	3:30pm-5:30pm, Room TBA

Classroom Behavior Policy

To foster a positive learning environment, students and instructors have a shared responsibility. We want a safe, welcoming, and inclusive environment where all of us feel comfortable with each other and where we can challenge ourselves to succeed. To that end, our focus is on the tasks at hand and not on extraneous activities (e.g., texting, chatting, reading a newspaper, making phone calls, web surfing, etc.).

Students are asked to refrain from disruptive conversations with people sitting around them during lecture. Students observed engaging in disruptive activity will be asked to cease this behavior. Those who continue to disrupt the class will be asked to leave lecture or discussion and may be reported to the Dean of Students.

Safety on Campus and in the Classroom

For a list of emergency procedures for all types of incidents, please visit the website of the Critical Incident Response Team (CIRT): https://cirt.arizona.edu/case-emergency/overview

Also watch the video available at

https://arizona.sabacloud.com/Saba/Web_spf/NA7P1PRD161/app/me/ledetail;spf-url=common%2Flearningeventdetail%2Fcrtfy000000000003841

University-wide Policies link

Links to the following UA policies are provided here: https://catalog.arizona.edu/syllabus-policies

- Threatening Behavior Policy
- Student Code of Academic Integrity
- Nondiscrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy
- Disability Syllabus Statement
- Religious Accommodation Policy
- Absences pre-approved by the University Dean of Students (or dean’s designee) will be honored.

Department-wide Syllabus Policies and Resources link

Links to the following departmental syllabus policies and resources are provided here, https://www.cs.arizona.edu/cs-course-syllabus-policies :

- Department Code of Conduct
- Illnesses and Emergencies
- Obtaining Help
- Confidentiality of Student Records
- Land Acknowledgement Statement

Subject to Change Statement

Information contained in the course syllabus, other than the grade and absence policy, may be subject to change with advance notice, as deemed appropriate by the instructor.